Mahendra Balal

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PROFILE

Results-driven Full-Stack Developer specializing in MERN & Next.js Stack with hands-on experience in deploying 10+ apps. Skilled in API integrations, performance optimization, and Agile workflows to deliver scalable solutions and enhance user experiences.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder | mentalwellnessapps.com | Remote *Nov 2025– Present*

- Built a mental wellness platform using Next.js and Supabase, offering evidence-based support for anxiety, stress, and loneliness.
- Created a secure and privacy-focused user experience, enabling stigma-free access to mental health support without barriers, integrating responsive, user-friendly interfaces optimized for seamless use across devices and improved engagement.

Co-founder | indoordogpark.org · citiesinnepal.com | Remote *09/2024-Present*

- Built directory platforms (US dog parks, Nepal cities) and full-stack apps using Next.js, Supabase with location-based search
- Implemented interactive maps powered by OpenStreetMap and designed intuitive navigation for enhanced user experience.
- Managed scalable backend systems with Supabase for efficient data storage, querying, and updates across platforms.
- Deployed applications on Vercel and integrated Sanity CMS for streamlined content management for article/blog page.

API Integration Intern | Kariz | Remote *09/2024-12/2024*

- Engineered and deployed an Integration Platform, leveraging Agile principles to automate 10+ API integrations.
- Optimized real-time data transformation using JSONata, implemented JSONSchemaValidator, boosting API reliability by 25%.
- Simplified 3rd-party API integrations, designing custom scripts and testing with Postman, reducing manual data entry by 30%.

Trainee Developer | Ironhack Bootcamp | Porto *Feb 2024 – Aug 2024*

E-Commerce Platform (Local Handicraft) · Jul – Aug 2024

- Built e-commerce site with secure payments and UI/UX using MERN tech; reduced load times 50%, React & MongoDB tuning
- Automated CI/CD workflows with GitHub Actions and API testing with Postman, achieving 99.9% uptime.

Job Search Platform (Career Building) · Apr – Jun 2024

- Built job search app with CRUD using React Router, Node.js, JSON Server; improved API response times 50% via caching sys.
- Designed responsive UI with HTML5/CSS3/React; A/B tested for user satisfaction; applied Git branch protection for collab.

Browser Game (X Motor Bike) · Feb – Apr 2024

- Built a bike racing game using vanilla HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript, featuring dynamic obstacles and a lives system to enhance replayability.

EDUCATION

Full Stack Web Development | Ironhack | Porto *02/2024-08/2024*

- Built interactive UIs with JavaScript, React, and Context API; established RESTful APIs with Node.js and Express.
- Handled NoSQL databases with MongoDB and Mongoose; utilized Git and GitHub for version control and CI/CD.
- Ensured code quality with Jest and Mocha; collaborated in Agile teams; deployed applications on Netlify and Heroku.

MSc in Finance | University of Bedfordshire | Luton, UK *08/2011-02/2013*

- Built a strong foundation in data interpretation, stakeholder communication, and digital business management.
- These skills directly inform how I design scalable, commercially-aware applications and collaborate in Agile teams.

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

Front-End Development | CodeYourFuture | London, UK 01/2021- 04/2023

- HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, React, Tailwind CSS, and version control with Git.

Responsive Web Design | FreeCodeCamp | Remote 02/2019-07/2022

- HTML, CSS, Flexbox, Grid, and media queries for adaptable layouts.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, React.js, TypeScript, Node.js, Express.js | Databases: MongoDB, Mongoose, Supabase | Tools & Testing: Git, GitHub Actions, Postman, Jest, Mocha, Selenium | Deployment Platforms: Netlify, Fly.io, Vercel, Heroku | Other Tools: Figma (UI/UX), JSONata, JIRA

SOFT SKILLS

Problem-Solving | Team Collaboration | Analytical Thinking | Communication | Adaptability | Time Management

LANGUAGES: English (Proficient) | Nepalese (Native) | Hindi (Conversational) | Portuguese (Beginner)

***Availability**: Immediate | Work Authorization: Remote worldwide | Eligible to work in Portugal*